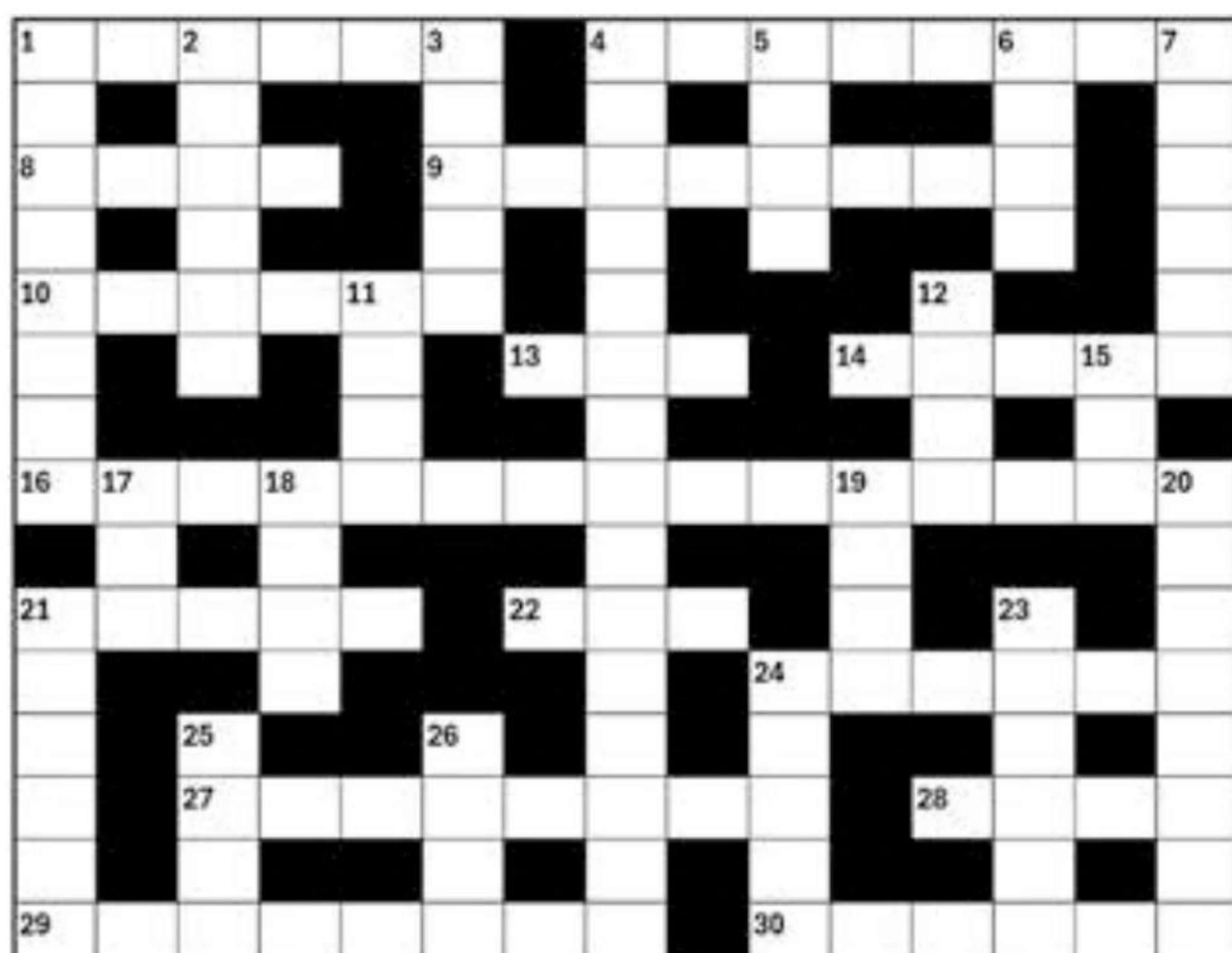


CROSSWORD

N. SOORYA PRAKASH



SOLUTION TO LAST FORTNIGHT'S CROSSWORD

ACROSS

- 4** Identify the first name of women's Rapid winner in the prestigious Tata Steel Chess held in January 2026. (8)
- 8 & 1** Which team was crowned the ISL champion for the 2025-26 season? (4,6)
- 9** Identify the first name of this Russian who won the women's doubles at Wimbledon & the WTA Final in 2025. (8)
- 10** Identify the first name of this Swede tennis star who was ranked World No. 1 in both singles & doubles during his playing days. (6)
- 13** What is the acronym of the premier T20 cricket league in Pakistan? (1,1,1)
- 14** Identify the first name of this former Indian medium pacer who announced his retirement from all forms of the game on December 3, 2025. (5)
- 16** Who became the 97th chess Grandmaster of India? (1,1,13)
- 21** Identify the surname of this bowler who became the first left-arm-wrist-spinner to take five wickets in a T20I. (5)
- 22** What is the acronym of the premier football league in India? (1,1,1)
- 24** Identify the first name of this bowler who took 19 wickets for Royal Challengers Bengaluru in IPL 2026. (6)
- 27** Which last surviving Indian cricketer from its first-ever Test win 1952, died in April 2026? (8)
- 28** Identify the surname of this former Dutch judoka who won bronze medals in the 100kg category at the 2008 & 2012 Olympic Games. (4)
- 29** Which country won the UEFA Nation's League title for the 2024-25 season? (8)
- 30** Identify the first name of this former German footballer — a silver boot winner in the 2014 World Cup and a

Bayern Munich legend — who retired in July 2025. (6)

DOWN

- 1** Identify the first name of this Zimbabwean who was the player of the match for his 4-17 versus Australia in the T20 World Cup group match in February 2026. (8)
- 2** Identify the first name of this English cricketer who lost 10 consecutive tosses in Tests as captain. (6)
- 3** Identify the first name of this Armenian who led his country to Chess Olympiad wins in 2006, 2008 & 2012. (5)
- 4** Who won the pole vault event at the Diamond League in Stockholm in June 2026, upsetting the world champion Armand Duplantis? (6,9)
- 5** Identify the first name of the former English all-rounder who was also instrumental in starting Kerry Packer's World Series Cricket. (4)
- 6** Identify the first name of this Chinese swimmer who won a gold medal at the 2024 Paralympic Games in 50m backstroke S5, an event in which he won the World Championships also in 2023 & 2025 (4).
- 7** Identify the first name of this cricketer who won the player of the series award in the recent ODI series between Pakistan and Australia. (6)
- 11** Identify the first name of this West Indies cricketer who scored a double hundred versus Sri Lanka in the first Test in North Sound in June 2026. (4)
- 12** Identify the first name of this retired Irish cricketer also played international cricket briefly for England, who took three wickets in Ireland's upset win over Pakistan in the group match of the 2007 cricket World Cup. (4)

- 15** FTB: "___ Shield" is the historic annual football competition organised by the Indian Football Association. (1,1,1)
- 17** What is the acronym of this basketball body in America which later became NBA? (1,1,1)
- 18** Identify the first name of this legendary English footballer who holds the record of scoring the most number of goals in Premier League history. (4)
- 19** Identify the surname of this cricketer who became the first player in ODI history to be given out "obstructing the field." (4)
- 20** Identify the surname of this Kiwi who scored a hundred versus England in the second Test at The Oval. (8)
- 21** Identify the surname of this former Australian cricketer who became the first to wear a full helmet in a Test. (6)
- 23** Identify the first name of this umpire who ruled Maninder Singh lbw in the Chepauk Test in 1986 which resulted in a famous tie, and who passed away recently. (6)
- 24** Identify the first name of the former Indian tennis star who is named as Chef de Mission of the Indian contingent for the forthcoming Commonwealth Games to be held in Glasgow. (5)
- 25** Identify the first name of this former Croatian footballer who was appointed as Tottenham Hotspur's interim manager for February-March 2026. (4)
- 26** Identify the surname of this legendary Chinese gymnast who won six medals at the 1984 Los Angeles Olympics which was also the very first Olympics in which the People's Republic of China participated. (4)